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#2
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FEATURING SAM RAIMI'S CLASSIC CHARACTERS!
THE EVIL DEAD
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THE EVIL DEAD

Book 2 of 4

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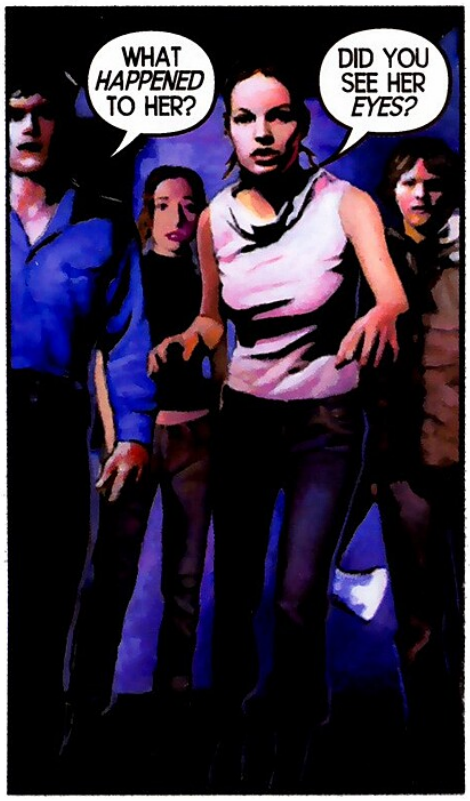
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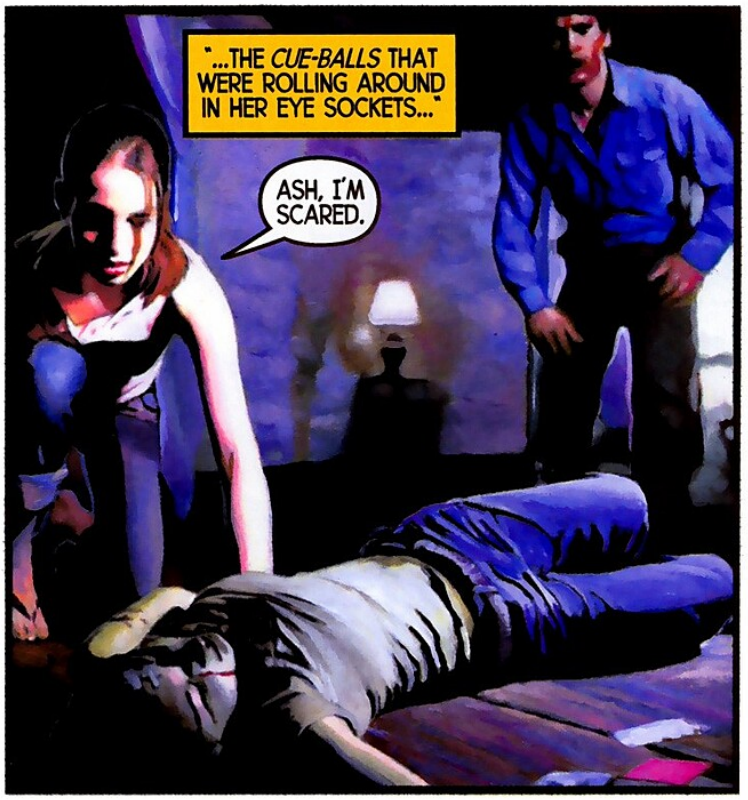
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HRRRRRRRR!
"SO CHERYL WAS FLOATING IN MID-AIR, GROWLING LIKE A '68 MUSTANG, MUTTERING SOMETHING ABOUT HER ANCIENT *SLUMBER*...
"...AND ALL I COULD THINK WAS THAT I WAS *NEVER* GETTING LAID.
"GUESS THAT WAS A LITTLE SELFISH.


"AT FIRST, I THOUGHT MAYBE SHE WAS *DISEASED,* LIKE SHE'D SUFFERED SOME BADASS *INSECT BITE*...
"...BUT THAT COULDN'T EXPLAIN HER *GOODYEAR BLIMP* TRICK..."


WHAT *HAPPENED* TO HER?
DID YOU SEE HER *EYES?*


"...THE *CUE-BALLS* THAT WERE ROLLING AROUND IN HER EYE SOCKETS..."
ASH, I'M SCARED.

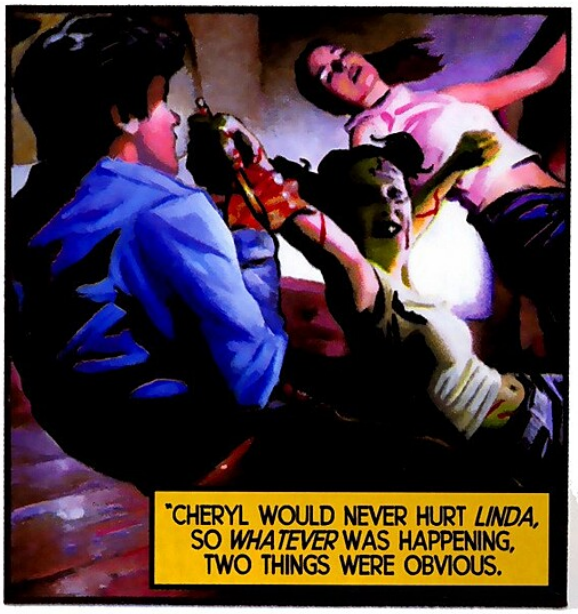

"...AND WHATEVER THE HELL WAS GOING ON WITH HER *FACE.*"


WHAT'S ***WRONG*** WITH HER?


"HAD WE REALLY UNLOCKED SOME MYSTICAL SPELL, ACCIDENTALLY RELEASING *DEMONIC FORCES* INTO OUR WORLD?"
EEEEYAAHHH!!!


"NOTHING ELSE MADE ANY *SENSE.*"
SPTCH


EEAAAUUGHH!


"CHERYL WOULD NEVER HURT *LINDA*, SO *WHATEVER* WAS HAPPENING, TWO THINGS WERE OBVIOUS.


"IT WAS TIME TO HIDE THE REST OF THE *PENCILS*...


FWWWKMP
"...AND CHERYL WASN'T CHERYL ANYMORE."
UMMPHH!


"AND IF WHATEVER SHE HAD BECOME COULD DO THAT TO LINDA...


"...WHAT WOULD THIS BITCH DO TO ME?

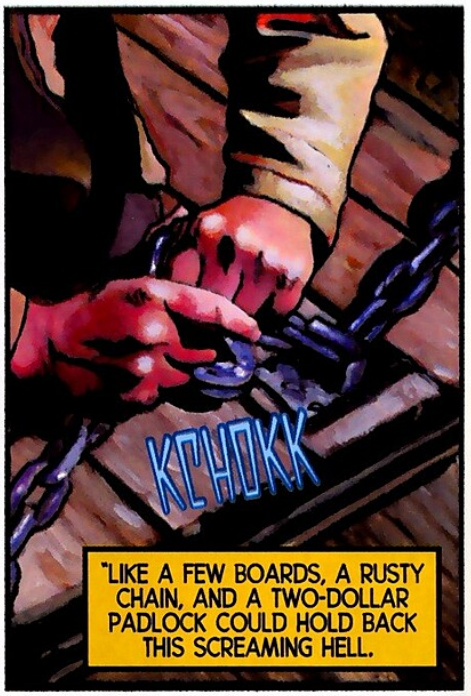

"LUCKY FOR ME, SCOTTY TURNED THAT INTO A *RHETORICAL* QUESTION."
KRAK
STOP IT!


"GOTTA GIVE CREDIT WHERE CREDIT IS DUE. THE *HELL-WHORE* MANAGED TO ACCOMPLISH SOMETHING I'D BEEN TRYING FOR OVER *TEN YEARS*..."
GGGGHHHHGGGEEE...


"SHE FINALLY GOT *SCOTTY* TO SHUT HIS *PIE-HOLE!*
PNNT

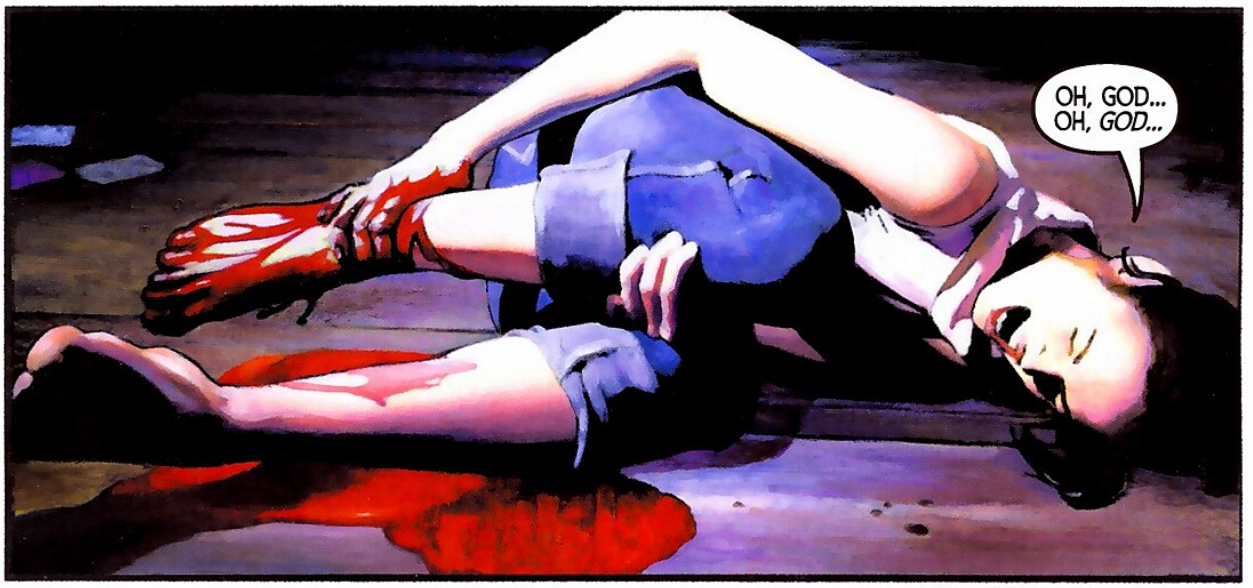

"LOOKING BACK, THE DEMON WENT INTO THE CELLAR WITHOUT MUCH OF A *FIGHT.*


"MAYBE THAT WAS PART OF THEIR SICK *PLAN.*
"GIVE US A LITTLE *HOPE...* LET US THINK THERE WAS A CHANCE WE'D *SURVIVE.*


KCHOKK
"LIKE A FEW BOARDS, A RUSTY CHAIN, AND A TWO-DOLLAR PADLOCK COULD HOLD BACK THIS SCREAMING HELL.


"SONS OF BITCHES WERE JUST GETTING *WARMED UP.*"


LINDA...

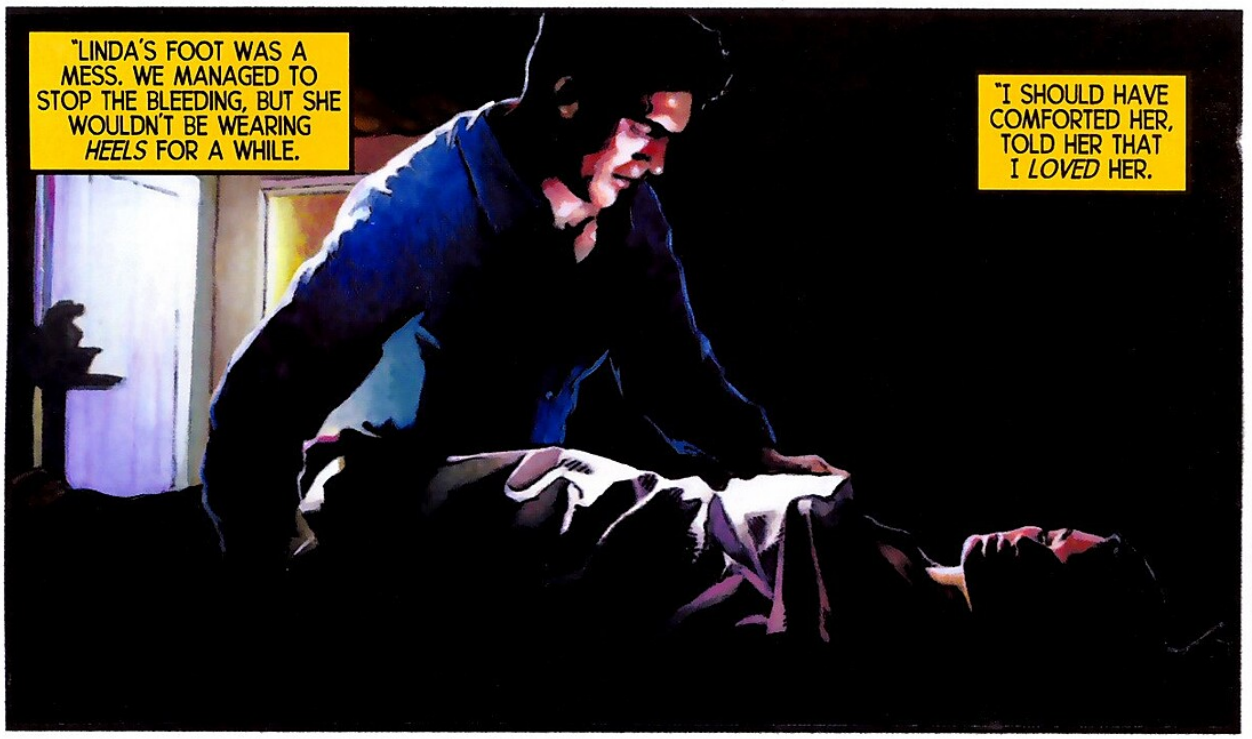

OH, GOD...
OH, *GOD*...

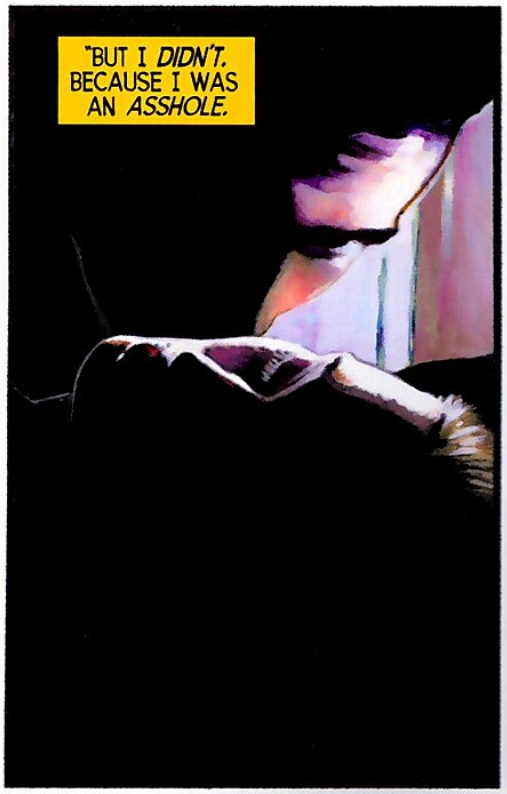

IT'S GONNA BE OKAY, BABY. IT *LOOKS* WORSE THAN IT IS!
TAKE IT EASY, LINDA.
I'M SURE CHERYL DIDN'T *MEAN* IT...


HRNNG! JESUS, *GOD!* DIDN'T YOU SEE HER *FACE?!*
BITCH *MEANT* IT, ALL RIGHT!

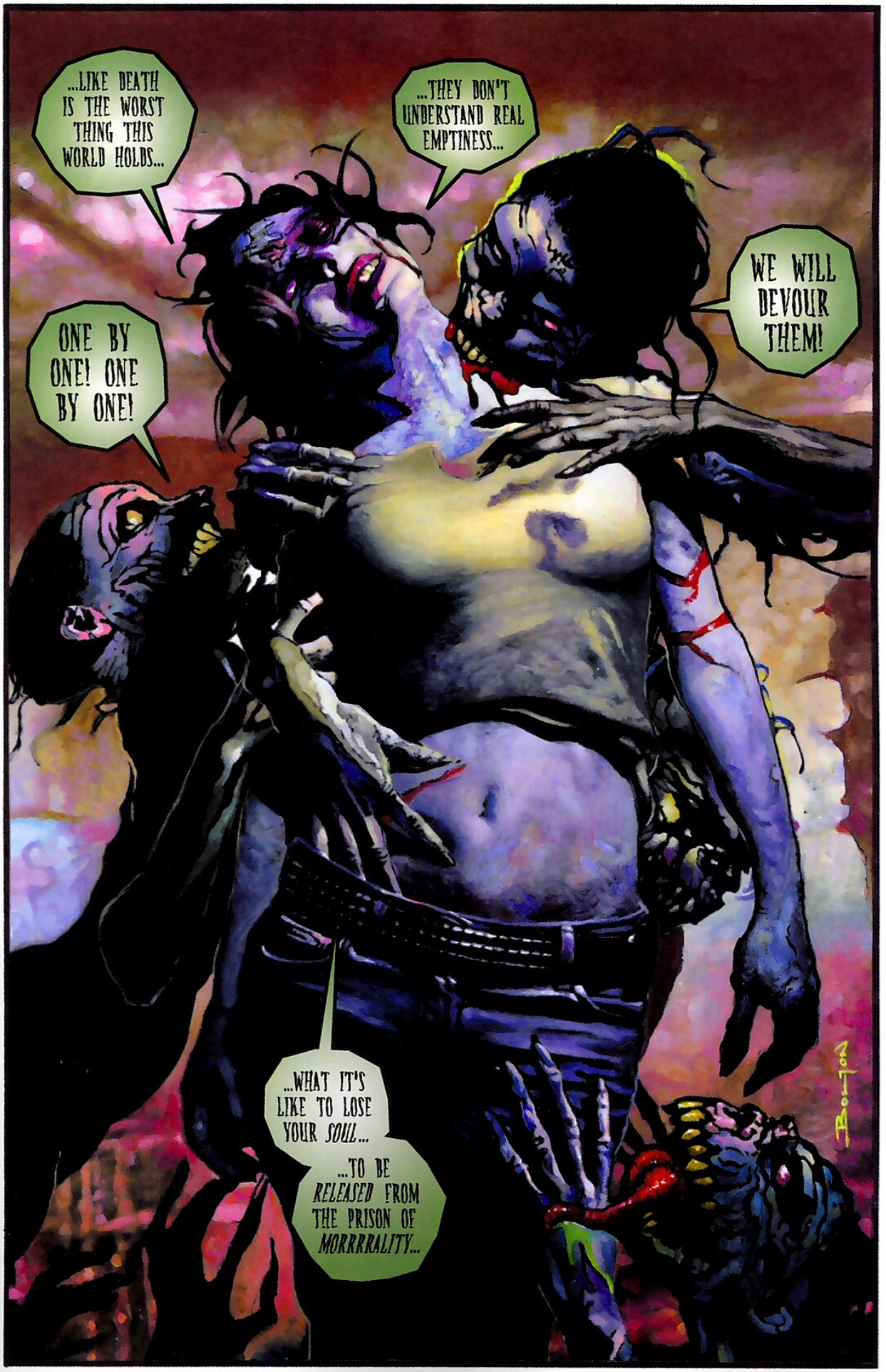

OH, GOD... MAKE HER *STOP!*
MAKE HER *STOP LAUGHING AT ME!!*
HEH HEE HEE! HEH HEH!


"SHOCK FINALLY HIT, AND LINDA *PASSED OUT.*
"THEN IT GOT QUIET, AND WE REALIZED WE REALLY WERE ALL ALONE.


"LINDA'S FOOT WAS A MESS. WE MANAGED TO STOP THE BLEEDING, BUT SHE WOULDN'T BE WEARING *HEELS* FOR A WHILE.
"I SHOULD HAVE COMFORTED HER, TOLD HER THAT I *LOVED* HER.


"BUT I *DIDN'T.* BECAUSE I WAS AN *ASSHOLE.*

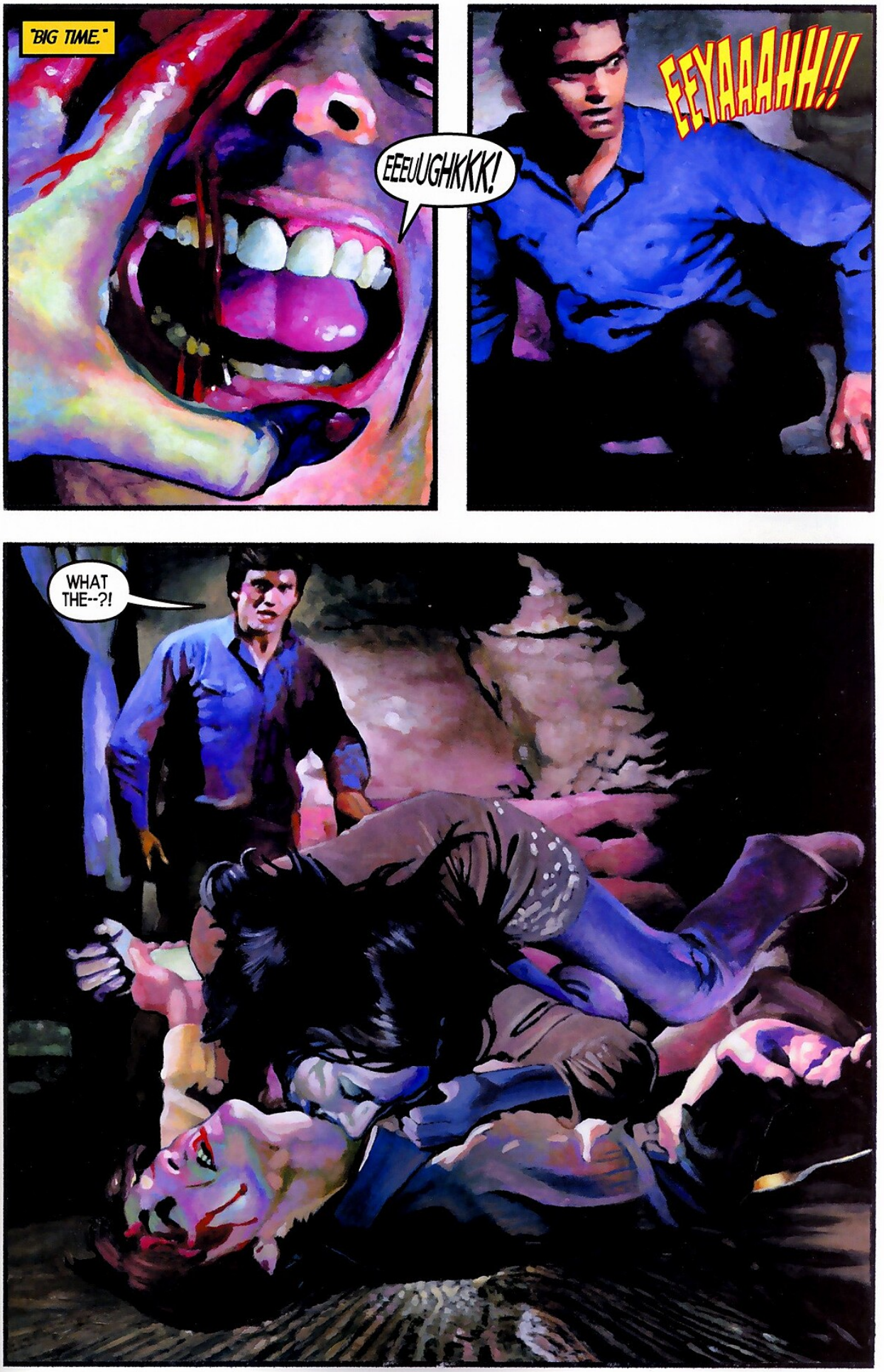

"SOMETIMES I WONDER IF *TELLING* HER MIGHT HAVE CHANGED WHAT HAPPENED LATER..."
CHERRRRRYL... TELL US HOW THEY *TASTE...*
HELP US FEEL THEIR *PAIN,* CHERRRRYL... THEIR *FEAR...*
THEY'RE ALL SO AFRAID TO *DIE...*


...LIKE DEATH IS THE WORST THING THIS WORLD HOLDS...
...THEY DON'T UNDERSTAND REAL EMPTINESS...
WE WILL DEVOUR THEM!
ONE BY ONE! ONE BY ONE!
...WHAT IT'S LIKE TO LOSE YOUR *SOUL*...
...TO BE *RELEASED* FROM THE PRISON OF *MORRRRALITY*...
BOLTON


IT'S STILL A FEW MORE HOURS 'TIL MORNING...
YOU WANT TO KNOW HOW THEY *TASTE*...?
LIKE *CHICKEN!* HEH HEE HEE!
ASH, I DON'T THINK WE CAN WAIT THAT LONG.
NO, WE *HAVE* TO! WE ALL HAVE TO!
THEN IN THE MORNING...WE'LL GET IN THE CAR...WE'LL TAKE THE BRIDGE, AND--
THERE'S NO BRIDGE! THERE'S NO NOTHING!
GOD...WHY DOES SHE KEEP MAKING THOSE *HORRIBLE NOISES?!* WHAT HAPPENED TO HER EYES?!
HEH! HEH HEE!
"TO TELL YOU THE TRUTH, SLUG-BAIT'S *PEEPERS* WERE THE LEAST OF OUR PROBLEMS."
HEH HEE! HEEEE...


"GUESS IT HADN'T SUNK IN YET..."
SCOTTY... I...I THINK SOMETHING'S *OUT THERE.*
"THIS PARTY WAS JUST GETTING *STARTED.*"
GO TO BED AND GET SOME SLEEP, OKAY?
"SO *DUMBASS* SENDS HIS GIRLFRIEND OFF *ALONE* TO CATCH FORTY WINKS.
"MAYBE, DEEP DOWN, WE THOUGHT THE *CABIN* WOULD PROTECT US AGAINST WHATEVER WAS STILL *OUTSIDE.*
"WE WERE JUST FORGETTING *ONE THING.*"
SKASH
YEEEAAGH!

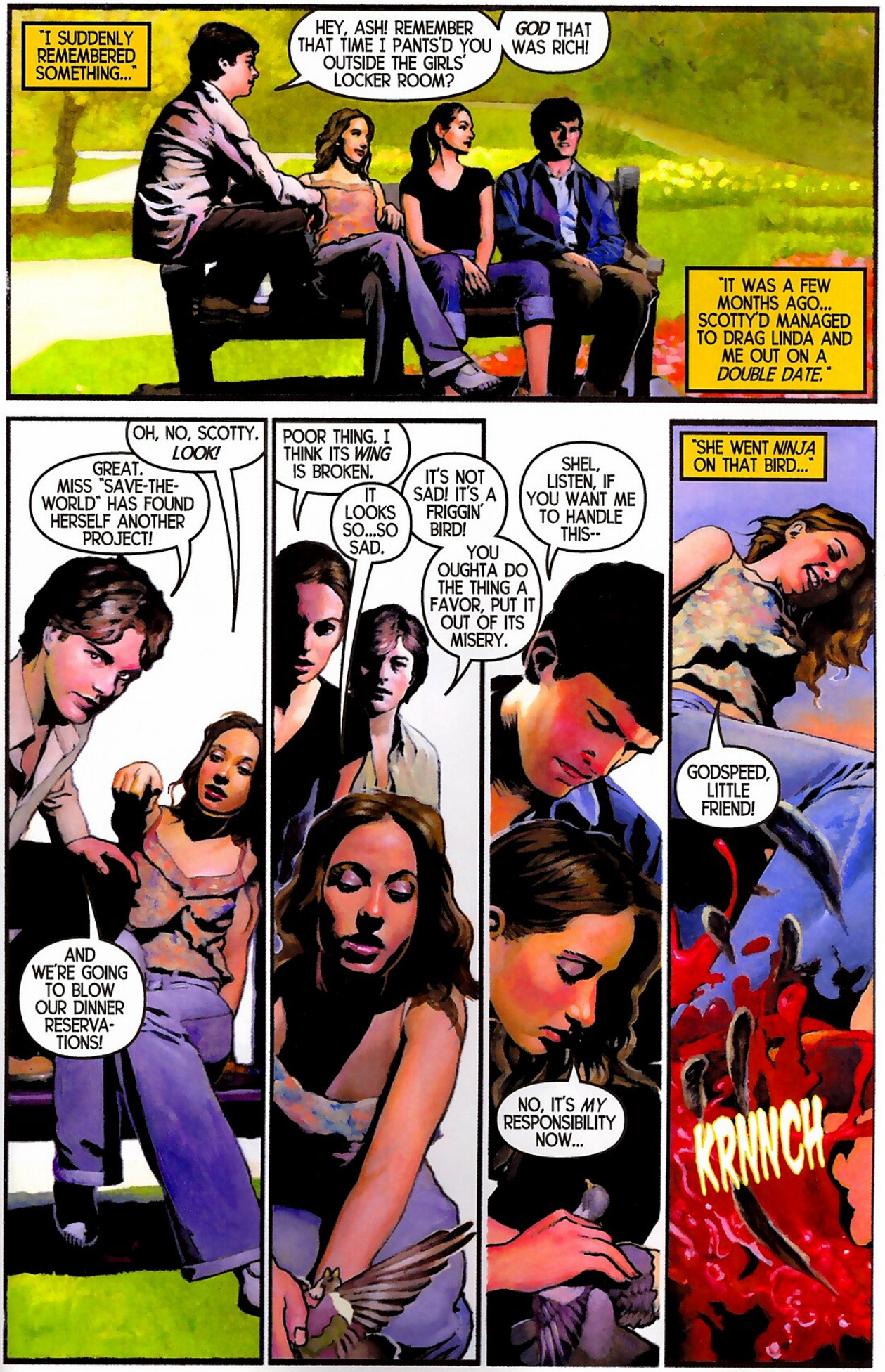

"THE CABIN BELONGED TO *THEM.*"
WHAT THE HELL--?!
SHELLY?
"EVERY BOARD. EVERY NAIL."
SH-SHELLY?
"EVEN THE AIR WE WERE *BREATHING.*
"THIS...EVIL...DIDN'T STOP WITH THE THINGS OUTSIDE OR WITH CHERYL... NO WAY, JOSE.
"I'D READ THE BOOK... *RELEASED THEM...*
"...WE'D BEEN CAUGHT *TRESPASSING...*
"...AND THE EVIL BASTARDS WERE GOING TO MAKE US ***PAY.***"
SHEL--


"BIG TIME."
EEEUUGHKKK!
EEYAAAHH!!
WHAT THE--?!


"I COULDN'T BELIEVE IT. I'D ONLY LEFT THEM ALONE FOR A *SECOND*..."
REEAAGHH...
"SUDDENLY I WAS GRASPING AT STRAWS... LOOKING FOR *ANY* EXPLANATION..."
ERRGHHHHH!
"BUG BITES WERE DEFINITELY *OUT.*
"I THOUGHT, OKAY, MAYBE THIS WAS ANOTHER OF SCOTTY'S STUPID *PRANKS*...
"...ANY SECOND NOW THEY'D BOTH BREAK OUT *LAUGHING.*


"HARDY HAR HAR."
EAGHH! AHHHH! RGHHH!
SHELLLLLLY!!
THANK YOU... YOU HAVE PRETTY SKIN.
MY PRETTY FLESH WAS BURNING. NOW GIVE US YOURS!!


"YOU'D LIKE TO THINK, IN THESE SITUATIONS, THAT YOU'D FIND THE STRENGTH TO DO THE *RIGHT THING.*"
HRRAA!
KMMP
"THEN ANOTHER *BOOKCASE* FALLS ON YOUR HEAD, AND SUDDENLY ALL YOUR HEROIC PLANS GO TO PIECES."
JOIN US... JOIN US...
URK! GHKK!
"SHE WAS GOING TO KILL HIM.
"THAT THING IN THE CELLAR WASN'T CHERYL ANYMORE, AND...GOD HELP ME, THIS WASN'T *SHELLY*..."
JOIN US!
EAGGHHH!!!
"...OR WAS IT?


"I SUDDENLY REMEMBERED SOMETHING..."
HEY, ASH! REMEMBER THAT TIME I PANTS'D YOU OUTSIDE THE GIRLS' LOCKER ROOM?
GOD THAT WAS RICH!
"IT WAS A FEW MONTHS AGO... SCOTTY'D MANAGED TO DRAG LINDA AND ME OUT ON A *DOUBLE DATE.*"
OH, NO, SCOTTY. *LOOK!*
GREAT. MISS "SAVE-THE-WORLD" HAS FOUND HERSELF ANOTHER PROJECT!
AND WE'RE GOING TO BLOW OUR DINNER RESERVA-TIONS!
POOR THING. I THINK ITS *WING* IS BROKEN.
IT LOOKS SO...SO SAD.
IT'S NOT SAD! IT'S A FRIGGIN' BIRD!
YOU OUGHTA DO THE THING A FAVOR, PUT IT OUT OF ITS MISERY.
SHEL, LISTEN, IF YOU WANT ME TO HANDLE THIS--
NO, IT'S *MY* RESPONSIBILITY NOW...
"SHE WENT *NINJA* ON THAT BIRD..."
GODSPEED, LITTLE FRIEND!
KRNNCH


"...AND NOW SHE HAD THE SAME CREEPY *EXORCIST STARE* ON AS SHE WENT AFTER SCOTTY."
GEAAGH!


"WEIRD THING WAS, SHE WAS HIS DAMN *GIRLFRIEND.*"
WHCHOK


"I MEAN, THEY'D *SLEPT TOGETHER*... MADE *LOVE*...
"...THERE WAS A *SPECIAL CONNECTION*, RIGHT? A *BOND*...


"YOU'D THINK THAT WOULD'VE MEANT... *SOMETHING.*

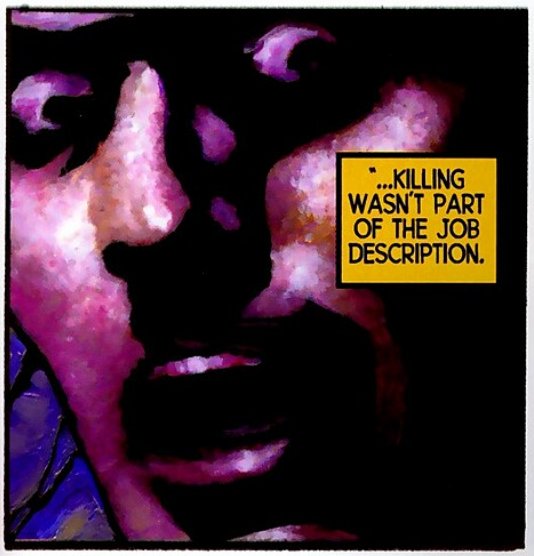

"NOPE. NO WAY, JOSE."
NNROWH
GOFF
GOFF
MNCH
MNCH
AAAH! HA HA HA HA HA!
ALL DONE.
NOW WHAT TIME WAS OUR *RESERVATION*?


ERAAAGHHH!
YOU'RE NOT HER! YOU'RE NOT SHELLY!!
"FOR ONCE, SCOTTY WAS RIGHT."
FAGGGHHH!
"SHELLY WOULDN'T EAT HER OWN HAND..."
Ghuk! Ghrrk! guk! hk!


SCOTTY? IS SHE...?
"...AND SHE SURE AS HELL WOULDN'T BE LYING *DEAD* IN SOME GODDAMN REMOTE *CABIN*...
"...OR COMING BACK LIKE SOME SICK *JACK-IN-THE-BOX.*"


REEAAARGHH!!


ASH! THE AXE! KILL IT!!
"HIT SHELLY? WITH AN AXE?
"I WAS THE GUY WHO WORKED A *CASH REGISTER* AT THE LOCAL DEPARTMENT STORE...


"...KILLING WASN'T PART OF THE JOB DESCRIPTION.


"BESIDES, IF THESE REALLY *WERE* DEMONS, WHAT THE HELL COULD *I* DO ABOUT IT?"


SHHTUNNK
"WELL, THERE WAS THAT."
WHHKK
KNNCH
"AND THAT. AND THAT."
SCOTT? WHAT'RE WE GONNA DO?
WE...WE'RE GONNA BURY HER...
...OUTSIDE...
HEEE! HEE HEH HEH!



"Whatever the hell had crawled inside them… Kandarian demon-scum or just a bad case of cat scratch fever… I was gonna have to *play dirty* or *die*."

Ash struggles to save his girl and his sanity, as those fallen to the destructive deadites move in for the final kill! Relive the original thrilling *Evil Dead* experience in the officially authorized comic book EXPANSION of Sam Raimi's classic film, featuring gorgeous-and-gory painted interiors by John Bolton (*Army of Darkness*, *Harlequin Valentine*) and some of the best new Ash quips ever, penned by our interstellar scribe Mark Verheiden (*Battlestar Galactica*, *My Name is Bruce*)!

DEADITE LETTER OFFICE

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Welcome back to the cabin, dear deadites and wriggling readers! When I watched The Evil Dead *for the first time, alone in my parents' old house in rural Louisiana, something definitely changed in my little thirteen-year-old head. It was a night of—well, enough from me. Maybe I'll tell the whole story in next issue's column. Onwards to letters! I asked a few Dark Horse Comics co-workers to remember when* they *first saw* The Evil Dead . . .

Dear Deadite Crew,
Okay, so I saw these movies in reverse order, but a few years ago we had some folks over on Halloween for a pre-party costume prep front-loading sorta thing, and I rented *The Evil Dead* and played it with the sound down while listening to the Beatle's "White Album," on vinyl, side four. I specifically remember the scene with his hand scribbling in the book while listening to "Good Night" sung by Ringo. It actually matched up eerily well.
—Rich P. (Pre-Press)



Thanks, Rich! The first time I heard "Revolution 9," it scared me almost as much as The Evil Dead *did. You and Danger Mouse have inspired me to work on a remix of the "White Album" using only Linda's* Evil Dead *dialogue and deadite cackling.*

Dear *Evil Dead* letters column,
I was one of the lucky few who was protected from the harsh fist of society by having my TV/movie watching habits highly monitored by my lovely parents. Due to this fact, I did not happen upon the first *Evil Dead* 'til my freshman year in high school ('95!). Being so cinematically challenged, I couldn't help but be instantly shocked, awed, and completely (from then on out) *terrified of trees!* It was there that my downward spiral into the world of horror began, but nothing will ever take the place of my first true love. So thanks to *The Evil Dead*, for helping to open my eyes to the world around me, one multi-colored-blooded demon at a time!
Sincerely,
—"Bloody" (Sales)

Hey, Li'l Bloody, thanks for writing! You can't avoid that harsh fist of society for long! Deadite Linda (played by Betsy Baker) may have been my first true horror crush, despite that little twitch of hers. A downward spiral, indeed.

Dude,
The first time I saw *The Evil Dead* . . .

Back when I was in high school there was this girlfriend of mine, and for the sake of being diplomatic I'll omit her name here. Every year she'd have a Halloween party. If memory serves, it was my sophomore year in high school, and I had just discovered Ash from his third movie. It was decided that we'd watch a marathon of *The Evil Dead*, *Evil Dead 2*, and *Army of Darkness*. That was going to be our Halloween party.

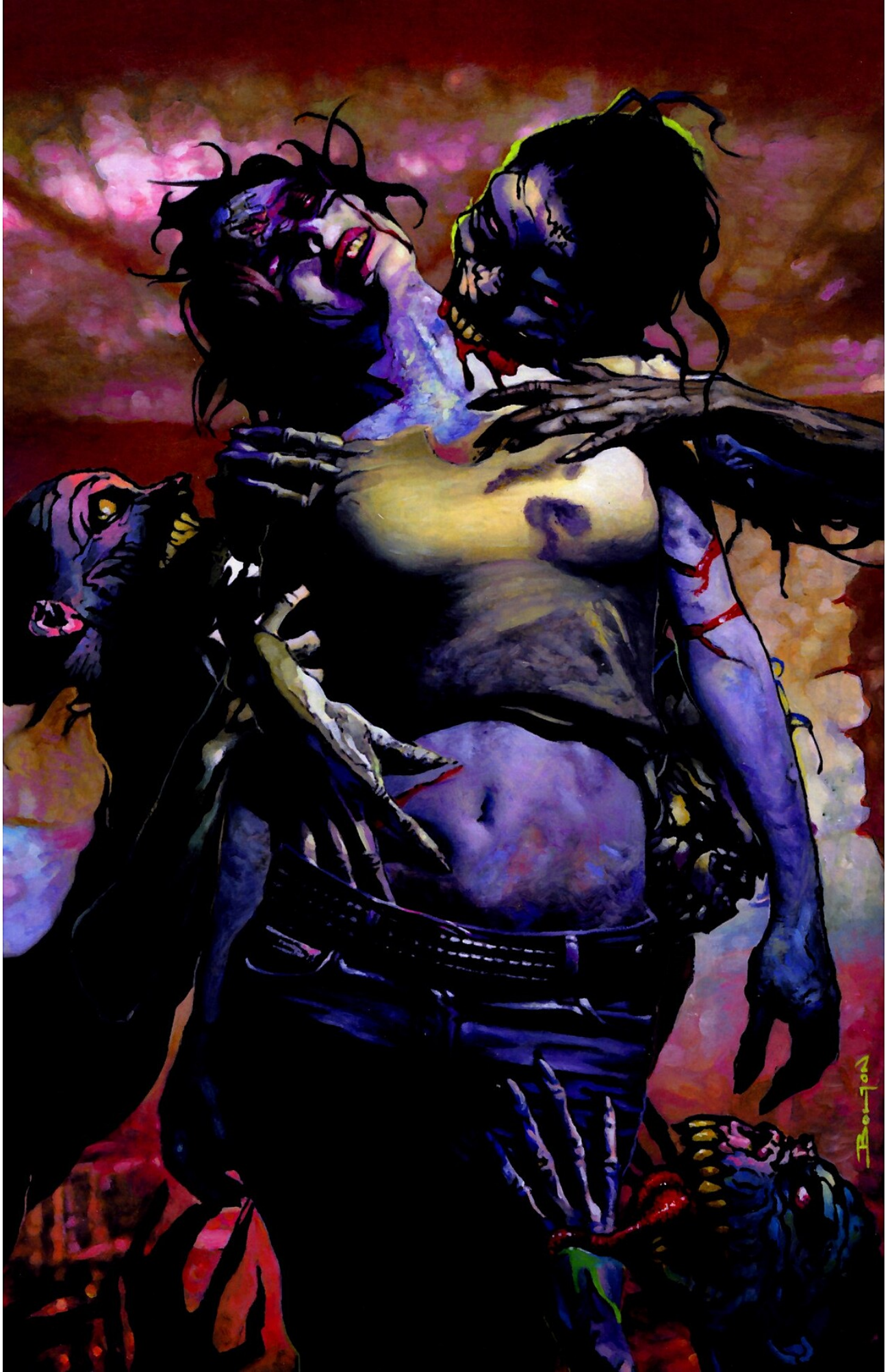
Now, before I go any further I'll divulge that I was a certain brand of delinquent in high school, and for the sake of keeping my job I'll omit most of the details here, but to get right to it—we were drinking. Drinking probably more then even adults should. So we started the movie and kept drinking. Needless to say, when the first pencil flew, some people, and for the sake of dodging ridicule from my coworkers, I'll admit that I was one of the "some people" who lost their lunch. The drinking, the gore, and the high-octane hormones in the air were to blame, because looking back now the part that made me ralph in my girlfriend's rose bushes wasn't even that gruesome. I returned to the movie and sobered up. Still to this day, whenever I watch *The Evil Dead* I make a nostalgic little puking noise when that pencil is worked around that poor girl's ankle.

So that's my first "memory" of the first time I saw *The Evil Dead*. Not totally glamorous, might get me in trouble with some people but, eh, you only live once right?
—Ryan Jorgensen (Editorial)

I must admit, that transformation following the stabbing is one of my favorite scenes in the whole film. What's yours? And are you catching any of the extra tidbits that Mark and John have added?? Please write to us using the info at the top of this page. See you in March, when Scotty says, "That's it. I'm getting out of here."

-P.S.

—Philip Simon


BOLTON


Minutemen
Help
Zone